Key Words

Consumer Protection	Consumerism
Consumer	Consumer movement
Caveat Emptor	Caveat Venditor
Buyer Beware	Consumer Grievances

What are the functions of the Consumer Clubs in schools?

The following basic structure of functioning is recommended:

i. Monthly meetings and demonstrations for one hour after school hours on the First Thursday of each month. Each month a topic / activity may be scheduled as in the model calendar.

ii. Days of National and International importance to consumers may be celebrated in the School / College. Poster / Speech / Essay competitions can be organised at school level by the Consumer Club to sensitise the students on the importance of the day.

iii. Field visits to local markets / Consumer Courts and door to door campaign in the local community etc., may be organized for at least 4 days in a year. It can be done on Saturdays with prior arrangement.

iv. Minutes of each activity have to be recorded by the Student and Teacher Co-ordinator jointly as properly document.

Mahatma Gandhi's quote about Consumerism

"What is a man if he is not a thief who openly charges as much as he can for the goods he sells?"

For own learning

Students should go to the nearest consumer court and watch the activities of the consumer court

Case Study

Mr.Narasimachary bought a refrigerator of a familiar brand with a warranty for seven years. He uses the fridge as per the guidelines given by the manufacturer. After the completion of two years the fridge went out of order. He was shocked, and approached the dealer. But the dealer refused to service the fridge at free of cost. What is your suggestion to Mr. Narasimachary to this grievance?

For Future learning

Students may collect further details regarding Consumer Protection. For this purpose, they may contact their District Collector and the Chairman, District Consumer Protection Council and also the Voluntary Consumer Organisation of locality with valid reputation to learn more about actual implementation of Consumer Protection Act in practice.

Exercise

IRBKGU

I. Choose the Correct Answers:

1. The term 'consumerism' came into existence in the year _____.

a) 1960 b) 1957

c) 1954 d) 1958

2. Who is the father of Consumer Movement?

a) Mahatma Gandhi

b) Mr. Jhon F. Kennedy

c) Ralph Nader

d) Jawaharlal Nehru

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